

Absolutely — **rent** is a strong polysemy target because your passage uses it here:

> “...small businesses always face challenges such as rising **rent** and strong competition...”

Here **rent** means **money regularly paid for the use of a shop, office, home, or other property that belongs to someone else**. But **rent** also works as a verb meaning **to pay to use something temporarily**, can mean **to let property to someone for payment**, and has a separate literary noun meaning **a tear or split**.

Word family: **rent / rental / renter**

Base word: rent

Verb forms: rent, rents, rented, renting

Related noun/adjective: rental

Related person noun: renter

Part of speech: noun (名詞) / verb (動詞)

Meaning in your passage: **rent = money paid regularly for use of property — 租金**

Your phrase:

> “rising **rent**”

Here **rent** means:

> **money paid regularly to the owner of a property for the right to use or occupy it.**

繁體中文：

為使用或佔用別人的店舖、辦公室、住宅等物業而定期支付的費用；租金

Natural translation:

> “rising rent”

「**不斷上升的租金**」

So here:

> **rent = 店舖 / 物業租金**

1. **rent = payment for using property — 租金**

The core noun meaning.

Practice 1 — Original

> “Small businesses face **rising rent**.”

「小企業要面對**不斷上升的租金**。」

Practice 2

> “The monthly **rent** is too high.”

「每月**租金**太高。」

Practice 3

> “They spend a large part of their income on rent.”

「他們把收入很大一部分花在**租金**上。」

rent = 為使用別人的住宅、店舖、辦公室、土地等而定期支付的金錢

2. **rent** = payment for temporary use of an item — 租用費；租金

A broader noun extension.

Practice 4

> “The equipment **rent** was included in the budget.”

「設備**租用費**已包括在預算內。」

Practice 5

> “The rent for the hall is charged by the hour.”

「禮堂的**租用費**按小時計算。」

rent = 為暫時使用不屬於自己的物件 / 場地而支付的費用

For many objects, **rental fee** is often more natural than bare **rent**.

3. **rent = verb, pay to use property temporarily — 租用；租住**

A major verb meaning.

Practice 6

> “They **rent** a small shop near the station.”

「他們在車站附近**租了一間小店**。」

Practice 7

> “She rents an apartment in the city.”

「她在市區**租住一個單位**。」

rent = 付款取得某物一段時間的使用權，而不是買下它

4. **rent = verb, pay to use an item temporarily — 租借；租用**

Practice 8

> “We **rented** a car for the weekend.”

「我們週末**租了一輛車**。」

Practice 9

> “You can rent equipment at the shop.”

「你可以在店裡**租用設備**。」

rent = 付費暫時使用車輛、設備、場地等

5. **rent something to someone = 把.....出租給某人**

This is the opposite perspective.

Practice 10

> “The owner **rents the shop to** a bakery.”

「業主把店舖**租給**一間麵包店。」

Practice 11

> “They rent rooms to students.”

「他們把房間**出租給**學生。」

rent something to someone = 物主把物業 / 物品交給別人使用並收取租金

This is important because **rent** can describe either side of the transaction.

6. **rent out = 出租**

This is a phrasal verb, so under your SOP I'll flag it briefly rather than fully develop it.

> “They **rent out** the upstairs room.”

「他們把樓上的房間**出租**。」

rent out = 把自己擁有的物業 / 物品租給別人

7. **for rent = 待租 ; 出租**

A very common fixed expression.

Practice 12

> “There is a shop **for rent** across the street.”

「街對面有一間店舖**招租**。」

Practice 13

> “The apartment is currently for rent.”

「這個單位目前**正在出租**。」

for rent = 某物業 / 物品現正可供租用

Especially common in AmE.

BrE often uses:

> to let

for property.

8. **rent-free = 免租的；不用付租金的**

Practice 14

> “The owner allowed them to stay **rent-free** for a month.”

「業主讓他們**免租**住一個月。」

Practice 15

> “The business received three months rent-free.”

「這間公司獲得三個月的**免租期**。」

rent-free = 不需要支付租金的

9. **rental = amount paid for temporary use — 租金；租用費**

A major related noun.

Practice 16

> “The car **rental** was expensive.”

「租車的**租用費**很高。」

Practice 17

> “Equipment rental is charged separately.”

「設備**租用費**另行收取。」

rental = 租用某物所支付的費用，或租用這件事本身

10. **rental = property/item available for rent — 出租物業；租賃物品**

Another noun use.

Practice 18

> “They found a short-term **rental** near the bakery.”

「他們在麵包店附近找到一個短期**出租單位**。」

Practice 19

> “The company manages holiday rentals.”

「這家公司管理度假**出租住宿**。」

a rental = 被租出去 / 可供租用的房屋、車輛或其他物品

11. **rental = relating to renting — 租賃的；出租的**

Adjective use.

Practice 20

> “The **rental market** is very competitive.”

「**租賃市場**競爭很激烈。」

Practice 21

> “They run a car rental business.”

「他們經營一家**租車公司**。」

rental + noun = 與出租 / 租用業務有關的

12. **renter = person who rents something — 租客；租用者**

Practice 22

> “The **renter** pays monthly rent.”

「**租客**每月支付租金。」

Practice 23

> “Young renters are especially affected by rising housing costs.”

「年輕**租客**特別受住屋成本上升影響。」

renter = 付費使用別人房屋 / 物品的人

For housing, **tenant** is often more precise.

13. **rent control = 租金管制**

A useful housing/policy compound.

Practice 24

> “The city introduced **rent control**.”

「城市實施了**租金管制**。」

Practice 25

> “Rent control limits how much landlords can raise rents.”

「**租金管制**限制業主可以加租的幅度。」

rent control = 政府對住宅租金水平 / 加租幅度所作的限制

14. **rent increase / rent rise = 加租 ; 租金上升**

Practice 26

> “The landlord announced a **rent increase**.”

「業主宣布**加租**。」

Practice 27

> “A sharp rent rise can hurt small businesses.”

「租金急升會打擊小企業。」

****rent increase / rise = 租金水平提高****

15. ****rent arrears = 欠租；拖欠租金****

A useful legal/housing term.

Practice 28

> “The tenant fell into ****rent arrears****.”

「租客開始****拖欠租金****。」

Practice 29

> “The landlord contacted him about unpaid rent.”

「業主因****欠租****聯絡他。」

****rent arrears = 已到期但尚未支付的租金****

Register:

* legal

* housing

* formal

16. ****rent = tear/split in material — 裂口；破口****

A genuinely distinct noun meaning, though more literary/formal today.

Practice 30

> “There was a large ****rent**** in the fabric.”

「布料上有一道很大的****裂口****。」

Practice 31

> “A rent appeared in the old curtain.”

「舊窗簾出現了一道**破口**。」

rent = 布料、表面等被撕開後形成的裂口

Register:

* literary/formal

* less common in everyday conversation than **tear**

17. **rent** = division/rift (文學 / 正式) — 裂痕 ; 分裂

A figurative extension of the “tear” sense.

Practice 32

> “The dispute created a deep **rent** in the organisation.”

「這場爭議在組織內造成嚴重**裂痕 / 分裂**。」

Practice 33

> “The event caused a rent in the relationship between the two groups.”

「這件事令兩個群體之間出現**裂痕**。」

rent — figurative = 關係、團體或社會中出現的嚴重分裂 / 裂痕

Register:

* literary

* formal

* uncommon compared with **rift**

Important distinction: **rent** vs **lease**

rent

usually everyday and can refer to shorter or general temporary use.

lease

usually more formal/legal, often involving a contract for a defined period.

> rent a shop

> = 租一間店

> sign a lease

> = 簽訂租約

For property, both can overlap strongly.

Important distinction: ****rent vs hire****

Regional difference matters.

****rent****

very common for:

* property

* cars

* equipment

****hire****

especially BrE, often used for temporary use of:

* cars

* equipment

* bicycles

> rent a car

> common everywhere, especially AmE

> hire a car

> very common BrE

But for property:

> rent a flat 

> *hire a flat*  normally

Important distinction: ****rent vs borrow****

rent

= pay to use temporarily.

borrow

= receive/use temporarily, usually without paying.

> rent a car

> = 付費租車

> borrow a friend's car

> = 借朋友的車

Very important.

Important distinction: **rent vs buy**

rent

= temporary right to use; ownership stays with someone else.

buy

= pay to become owner.

> rent a shop

> = 租店鋪

> buy a shop

> = 買下店鋪

Important distinction: **rent vs fee**

rent

specifically payment for temporary use of property/object.

fee

charge for a service or access.

> monthly rent

> = 每月租金

> membership fee

> = 會員費

Important distinction: **rent vs mortgage**

rent

= pay the owner/landlord for use.

mortgage payment

= repay money borrowed to buy property.

So:

* renter → does not normally own property

* homeowner with mortgage → owns it subject to financing

Important distinction: **rent vs tenant**

rent

= payment/action.

tenant

= person who occupies rented property under an agreement.

> pay rent

> = 交租

> tenant

> = 租客

Renter is broader; **tenant** is more specific for property.

Important distinction: **rent vs landlord**

tenant/renter

pays rent.

landlord

owns/controls the property and receives rent.

So:

> tenant rents the shop

> landlord rents the shop to the tenant

Same verb can describe both sides depending on grammar.

Important distinction: **rent a shop vs rent a shop to someone**

This is especially important.

Tenant perspective:

> "I rent a shop."

= 我租了一間店舖來用。

Owner perspective:

> "I rent the shop to a bakery."

= 我把店舖租給一間麵包店。

Grammar determines direction.

Important distinction: **rent vs rental**

rent

usually the regular payment or the verb.

> pay rent

> rent a car

rental

often:

* rental fee

* rented item/property

* relating to rental business

> car rental

> = 租車服務

> holiday rental

> = 度假出租住宿

Important distinction: **rising rent vs rent increase**

rising rent

describes an ongoing trend:

> 租金正在上升

rent increase

often refers to a specific rise imposed/announced:

> 加租 / 租金加幅

Your source uses the trend meaning.

Important distinction: **rent — payment vs rent — tear**

Same spelling, completely different meanings:

Property:

> “The rent is high.”

= 租金很高。

Tear:

> “There is a rent in the cloth.”

= 布上有裂口。

Excellent recognition-level MCQ contrast, though the second is much less common.

Family-extension sweep

After the full audit, the useful modern family includes:

- * **rent — property payment** = 租金
- * **rent — temporary-use payment** = 租用費
- * **rent — verb: tenant side** = 租用 / 租住
- * **rent — verb: owner side** = 出租給.....
- * **rent out** = 出租
- * **for rent** = 待租 / 招租
- * **rent-free** = 免租的
- * **rental — fee/activity** = 租用費 / 租賃
- * **rental — rented item/property** = 出租物 / 出租單位
- * **rental — adjective** = 租賃的
- * **renter** = 租客 / 租用者
- * **rent control** = 租金管制
- * **rent increase/rise** = 加租 / 租金上升
- * **rent arrears** = 欠租
- * **rent — tear** = 裂口 / 破口
- * **rent — figurative rift** = 裂痕 / 分裂

Master comparison

Form / sense	MCQ-ready Traditional Chinese meaning
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rent — property payment	為使用別人的住宅、店舖、辦公室等而定期支付的金錢
rent — temporary-use payment	為暫時使用場地、設備等支付的租用費
rent — tenant-side verb	付款取得某物一段時間的使用權，而不擁有它
rent — owner-side verb	把自己擁有的物業 / 物品交給別人使用並收取租金
for rent	某物業 / 物品現正可供租用
rent-free	不需要支付租金的
rental — fee/activity	租用某物所支付的費用，或租賃活動本身
rental — property/item	被租出去 / 可供租用的房屋、車輛或物品
renter	付費使用別人房屋 / 物品的人

rent control	政府限制租金水平 / 加租幅度的制度	
rent arrears	已到期但尚未支付的租金	
rent — tear	布料、表面等被撕開後形成的裂口	
rent — figurative rift	團體、關係或社會中的嚴重裂痕 / 分裂	

For your original phrase

> “...small businesses always face challenges such as **rising rent** and strong competition...”

The exact meaning is:

**rent = Golden Crust 為使用店舖物業而定期支付給業主的租金；rising rent 就是店舖租金不斷增加。 **

Natural translation:

> **「小生意永遠都會面對挑戰，例如不斷上升的租金和激烈競爭。」 **

The highest-value contrasts are:

- > **pay rent** → 交租
- > **rent a shop** → 租一間店來用
- > **rent the shop to someone** → 把店舖租給別人
- > **for rent** → 招租 / 待租
- > **rental** → 租賃 / 租用費 / 出租物
- > **renter** → 租客 / 租用者
- > **rent vs lease** → 一般租用 vs 較正式合約租賃
- > **rent vs borrow** → 付費租用 vs 借用
- > **a rent in the fabric** → 布料上的裂口